

Windows vs Linux

When it comes to web hosting, you have two choices - Windows or Linux. If you would like to host WordPress, Drupal, Joomla or any other PHP scripts, Linux is the best choice. In fact, Linux servers are fully compatible with PHP based software scripts and databases like MySQL. The Windows hosting will be beneficial if you would like to develop your website on Microsoft technologies with SQL Server or Microsoft Access database. The learning curve related to the management of emails, databases, backups will be easy in Linux than Windows hosting.

You should be careful not to register fully qualified domain name (.com/.net/.org) for free since it will have hidden conditions. You will not only have to shell out extra money for its renewal but also will find it difficult to regain the control of the domain name in future.

When to use Windows Hosting

If you want to host ASP.NET scripts and software (both readymade and custom) you can choose Windows based hosting platform. The server will be running Windows Server 2008/2012 with Microsoft SQL Server and MySQL database. Some providers will ask you to pay extra for SQL Server databases. Windows hosting can be managed with control panels such as HELM & WebsitePanel.

If you have a blog with free hosted URL like `yourname.wordpress.com`, you will not be able to create your own custom e-mail ids.

Moreover, you should opt for Windows hosting only if you have an intention to run scripts specific to Microsoft technologies. For example, you can install DotNetBlogEngine instead of WordPress without requiring



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